

MODY AI

Human Computer Interaction 25/26

WHO WE ARE?



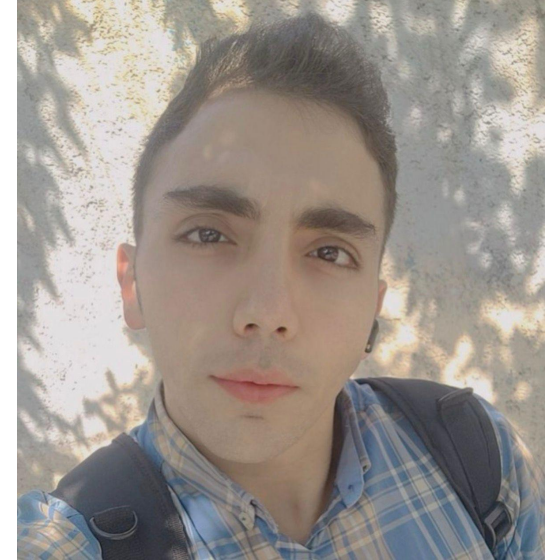
Zuhal Didem Aytac



Özgün Koçak



Mehmed Yusa Erguven

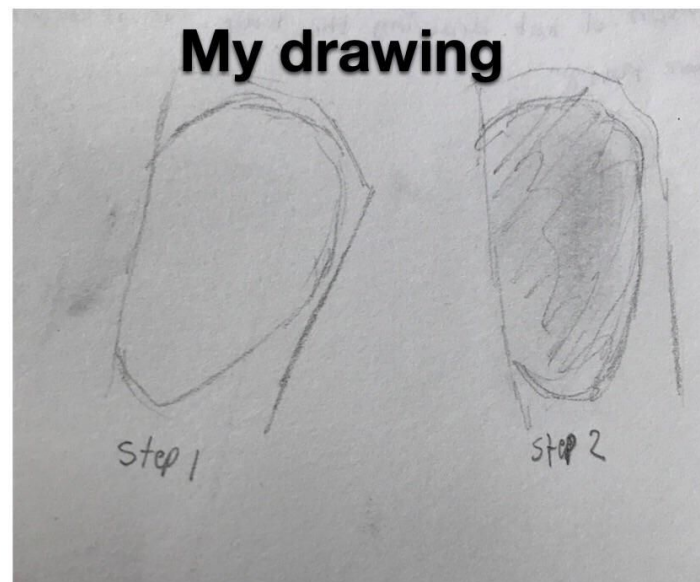
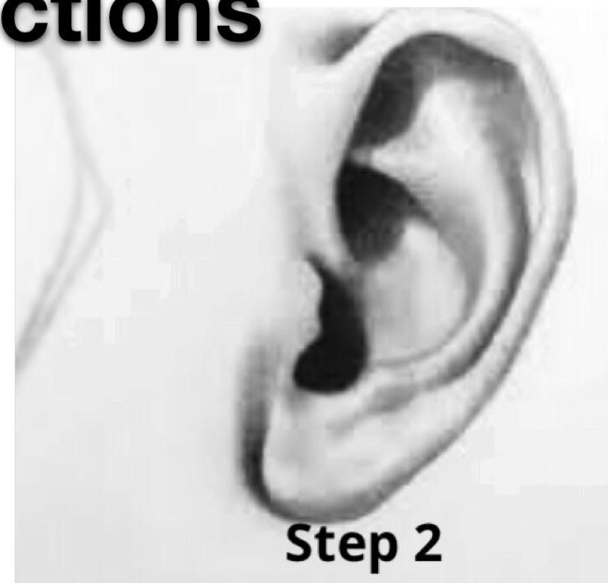
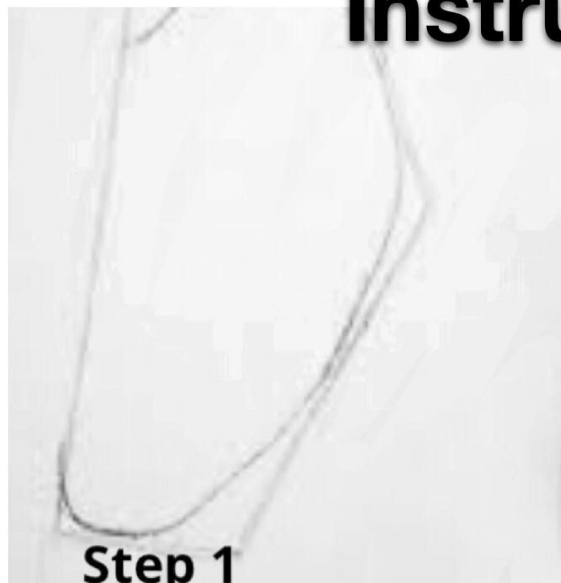


Mohammedreza Babaei

Domain: Learning to Draw as a Beginner

Many people are interested in drawing but find it difficult to improve on their own. Without clear guidance or feedback, it can be hard to know what to practice or how to start. We chose this domain because learning to draw involves a visible output that requires reflection and correction, which makes the process different from other types of self-learning. We wanted to understand how beginners approach drawing, what challenges they face, and how they find motivation or inspiration to continue.

Instructions



PARTICIPANTS

P1 - Selen Yukeb - amateur painter who paints as a hobby (immediate user)

P2 - Ewa Walkovska - art instructor and owner of a new art studio in Nizza, Torino (domain expert)

P3 - Giuseppe Martano - He improved his skills after series of art classes during middle and high school (lead user)

P4 - Selin Ozciftci - Exhibiting artist and art instructor in Turkey (domain expert)

Procedure:

Two team members were present at each interview: one leading the conversation, one taking notes.

Interview 1: Didem conducted the interview, and Yusa took notes.

Interview 2: Didem conducted the interview, and Yusa connected remotely on mobile to take notes. This included a short *observation during an art workshop*.

Interview 3: Özgün conducted the interview, and Mohammad Reza took notes.

Interview 4: Yusa conducted the interview while the rest of the team joined remotely.

All participants gave **written consent** for recording and data use.

Methodology – Rationale & Interview Process

Why they were chosen:

They represent a diverse set of perspectives: from beginners struggling to start, to an experienced teacher who mentors others, and a passionate self-taught artist. This diversity helped us capture emotional and practical needs of learners at different stages.

Recruitment:

Participants were reached through personal connections and local art communities. One interview included an on-site observation during an art workshop at Ewa's studio.

P1

Why chosen / appropriateness: She represents a typical adult beginner who draws casually without formal training. Her experience reflects self-taught learners who use online sources for inspiration.

Recruitment: Contacted through a team member's personal connection.

Profile: 26 years old, female, doctor by profession, draws as a hobby in her free time.

Interview location: Conducted face to face, in Torino

Observation and questions: We observed how she uses Pinterest for visual references. Questions focused on how she learns, what she finds difficult, and what keeps her motivated to continue.

Team roles: Didem led the interview and asked questions, Yusa took notes and handled the audio recording.

Materials used: Audio recorder on phone, notebook for notes.

P1 - Questions

- How did you first become interested in drawing?
- What made you start drawing again after stopping for a while?
- How often do you draw, and when do you usually find time for it?
- What kind of things do you usually like to draw?
- How do you decide what to draw each time
- Can you describe what happens when you sit down to draw — from start to finish?
- What do you find most difficult while drawing?
- How do you know when a drawing is finished?
- Where do you look for guidance or feedback on your drawings?
- Have you ever considered taking a class or joining a drawing group? Why or why not?
- How do you notice improvement in your drawings over time?
- What kind of environment helps you draw best?
- What motivates you to keep drawing even when you're busy or not satisfied with your results?
- Is there something that makes learning or improving more difficult for you?
- How do you feel when you compare your work to what you see online?
- What would make drawing as a hobby more enjoyable or easier to continue long term?
- If you could get help with something in drawing, what would it be?
- Is there anything else you'd like to add that we didn't cover?

P2

Why chosen / appropriateness: She is an experienced art instructor who recently opened her own workshop, making her an ideal domain expert to understand how drawing is taught and what challenges beginners face from a teacher's perspective.

Recruitment: Found through a Facebook post announcing the opening of her new art studio in Nizza. She agreed to participate after being contacted physically.

Profile: Female, late-20s, professional artist and instructor, teaches beginner and intermediate drawing courses.

Interview location: Conducted in person at her art studio in Nizza.

Observation and questions: We observed the studio setup, drawing materials, and ongoing student works displayed in the space. Questions focused on her teaching methods, student motivation, feedback practices, and reasons for opening the workshop.

Team roles: Didem led the interview and managed the in-person discussion; Yusa joined online to take notes and monitor the recording.

Materials used: Audio recording via phone, digital notes taken by Yusa, and photos of the studio environment and displayed artwork (with consent).

P2 - Questions

- How did you start teaching drawing, and what led you to open this workshop?
- What kinds of people usually attend your classes?
- What do you think attracts people to learn drawing here instead of online?
- From your experience, what usually motivates people to start learning to draw?
- What are the most common difficulties beginners face in the first lessons?
- How do you notice when someone starts improving or gaining confidence?
- How do you usually structure a beginner course or a typical class?
- Are there specific exercises or activities that work especially well for beginners?
- How do you give feedback to your students during or after class?
- What kind of feedback do students respond to best?
- How do you help students stay motivated when they get frustrated?
- What do you enjoy most about teaching drawing?
- How do you see the role of technology or digital tools in helping people learn art today?
- Is there anything else you'd like to add that we didn't cover?

P3

Why chosen / appropriateness: An artist who had art related projects all of his life. He paints regularly but doesn't feel confident. His distance to the technology, gave us more unbiased image.

Recruitment: Contacted through a team member's personal connection.

Profile: 65 years old, male, veterinarian, draws and makes DIY projects in his free time.

Interview location: Conducted face to face, in Chieri.

Observation and questions: Even tho he's been painting for 50 years, he never lost his interest in art. He solely follows his instincts and feelings, and didn't find the environment to work on new techniques. Not considering the digital tools didn't help him either.

Team roles: Özgün led the interview and asked questions, Matin took notes and handled the audio recording.

Materials used: Audio recorder on phone, notebook for notes.

P3 - Questions

- How did you get started with painting?
- What made you interested in painting?
- How long have you been painting, and how often do you do it?
- What do you enjoy most about painting?
- What are the hardest parts or most frustrating moments?
- How do you usually learn or improve your painting skills? (e.g., YouTube, classes, self-practice)
- What kinds of exercises or projects do you do to learn?
- What's something you wish was easier to learn?
- How do you know if you're improving?
- What materials or tools do you use (brushes, paints, tablets, etc.)?
- Do you paint digitally, physically, or both?
- Have you ever tried any digital painting tools, VR or AR apps?
- How does your painting environment affect your experience (lighting, space, mess, etc.)?
- Would you be interested in an AR/VR environment to help you paint or learn? Why or why not?

P4

Why chosen / appropriateness: She is an artist with some art pieces exhibited in some art galleries in Istanbul and also she is giving workshops on drawing to people from different ages. Thus it makes her a viable candidate for a domain expert to interview for our topic.

Recruitment: Contacted through a team member's personal connection.

Profile: 26 years old, female, artist and art instructor.

Interview location: Conducted via online video meeting

Observation and questions: Questions focused on her journey to become an artist and the motivations and teaching methods, student motivations and the challenges beginners are facing.

Team roles: Yusa led the interview and asked questions, Ozgun took notes.

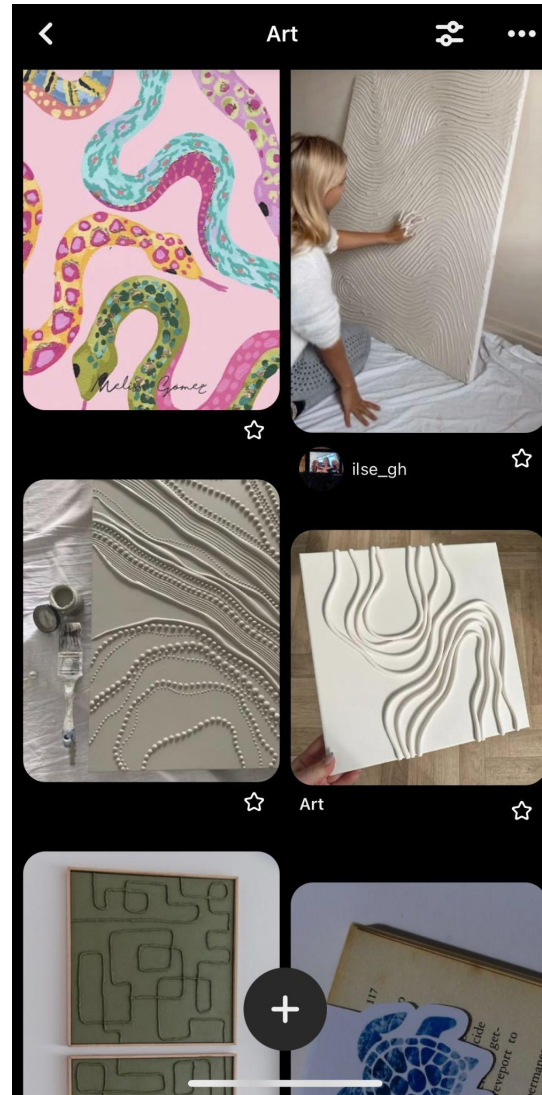
Materials used: Laptop for conducting the online meeting and for notes.

P4 - Questions

- Can you tell me about how you first got into drawing or painting?
- What made you want to continue — what hooked you early on?
- When you were learning, what parts of the process felt the most challenging or discouraging?
- Was there a specific turning point or experience that helped you grow as an artist?
- How has your relationship with drawing or painting changed over the years — from learner to professional?
- What inspired you to start sharing your creative process through workshops?
- What kinds of people usually join your workshops, and what do you think draws them to it?
- From your observations, what usually motivates people to start learning to draw or paint?
- What are some common challenges or fears you see in beginners?
- How do you notice when someone starts improving or gaining confidence?
- How do you usually structure a beginner course or a typical class?
- How do you balance teaching technique and encouraging creativity?
- Are there specific exercises or activities that work especially well for beginners?
- How do you give feedback to your students during or after class?
- What kind of feedback do students respond to best?
- How do you help students stay motivated when they get frustrated?
- What do you enjoy most about teaching drawing?
- In your view, what makes a good drawing teacher?
- How do you see the role of technology or digital tools in helping people learn art today?
- Is there anything else you'd like to add that we didn't cover?

ARTIFACTS

P1 - Artifacts



P2 - Artifacts



Expats in Turin · Katil
Ewa Walkowska · 8 Eyl · 🌐



NEW! Art Classes in English in Turin – for Kids & Adults

STARTING OCTOBER | SMALL GROUPS | NO EXPERIENCE NEEDED

Hi everyone!

I'm Ewa, a local artist and educator, and I'm opening a new creative space this October in Turin. It's called **Artive Workshop**, and it's for both kids and adults who wants to make art in an enriching, international space.

🎨 **Small groups**

📍 **Turin (final venue coming soon)**

! **Taught in English**

Never painted before? Perfect.

Used to love art but stopped? Even better.

This space is for you.

Interested? Want details when sign-ups open?

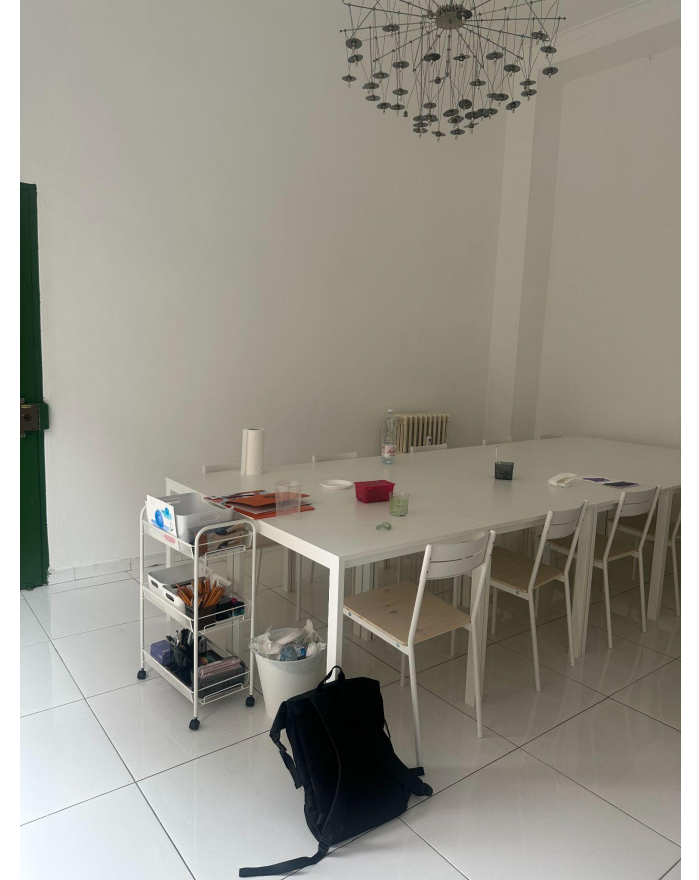
Just comment **"YES"** or emoji and I'll DM you the info - no obligations, just updates.

 Beğen  Yorum yap  Paylaş

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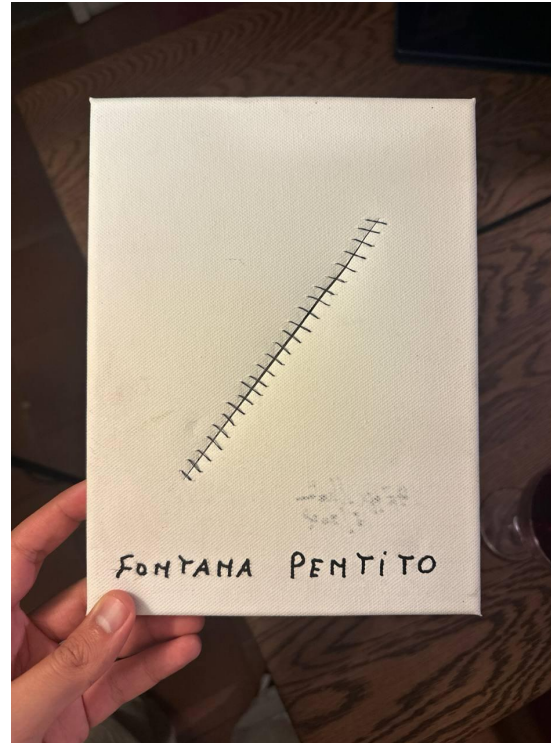
En alakalı ▾

 Didem Aytaç adıyla yoru...   





P3 - Artifacts



P4 - Artifacts



P4 - Artifacts



KEY QUOTES

P1 - Key Quotes

“When I sit down to draw, I reconnect with myself and disconnect from everything else.”

“Sometimes I feel stuck because I don’t know what to practice next.”

“I usually search for inspiration on Pinterest when nothing around me inspires me.”

“I would love to get help when I can’t draw something I imagine, but I don’t know who to ask.”

P2 - Key Quotes

“Many people start classes to get a creative outlet, a space that’s different from their everyday analytical work.”

“The biggest challenge for beginners is being too careful because they compare themselves to what they see online.”

“When students stop worrying about the final result, that’s when they really start improving.”

“For me, art is everything, my work, my hobby, my way to connect with people.”

P3 - Key Quotes

“The thing that i struggle most is not being able to represent my imagination on the canvas”

“I prefer calm environments; I can't paint in noisy places.”

“Oil painting is hard, one part of the painting can take days to dry.”

“I like to paint landscapes, even if i'm not there and see a picture of the place.”

“I'd love to learn the techniques that Monet was using in his paintings.”

P4 - Key Quotes

“I was very a emotional child and in daily life being emotional sometimes overwhelming. but when I was drawing, this emotion turned into something positive.”

“Many people just want to reconnect with themselves.”(answer is about motivations of people to go to workshops)

“The biggest fear of beginners is usually the fear of failure, not being good enough.”

“They respond best the honest but encouraging feedback when it's both positive and specific it reaches to them.”

“I also noticed that public appreciation like hanging their works on the wall for a mini exhibition builds confidence.”

“Patience and empathy are essential. It's not about showing how talented you are but about helping the others discover their own potential.”

FINDINGS

Emotional connection matters more than skill

Drawing is often a personal and emotional activity rather than a purely technical one. Learners value self-expression, relaxation, and enjoyment over mastery.

(Seen in P1 and P3: drawing for calm and focus; P2 and P4: encourages emotional confidence in students.)

Beginners fear judgment and lack feedback

Many hesitate to draw because they fear failure or criticism. They want guidance and reassurance, not evaluation.

(Seen in P1: avoids public feedback; P2 and P4: needs tools for gentle, quick feedback; P3: His superior classmates intimidated him.)

Tools and materials can be barriers

Uncertainty about how to use tools and limited access to materials often discourage practice. Learners need easier ways to experiment safely.

(Seen in P1: afraid to waste materials; P3: The nature of some elements makes them harder to practice ; P2: bridges traditional and digital media.)

Community and feedback improve learning

Learning with others boosts motivation and helps overcome self-doubt. Regular, kind feedback keeps learners engaged between sessions.

(Seen in all participants: desire for shared spaces or teacher-student connection; P2 stresses motivation between classes.)

Digital tools help, but can't replace the human touch

Technology can support creativity by offering inspiration or structure, but it should never replace the personal or emotional side of art.

(Seen in P1: uses Pinterest for ideas; P2 and P3: value balance between digital aids and traditional practice.)

NEEDS

P1 - User Needs

Needs a way to find inspiration easily when she feels stuck.

Needs to be able to get feedback and guidance without joining a formal class.

Needs a way to organize her drawing routine and stay consistent over time.

Needs to be able to experiment with materials safely without wasting them.

P2 - User Needs

Needs a way to help students overcome fear of failure and perfectionism.

Needs tools to give quick, personalized feedback in group sessions.

Needs a way to keep students motivated between classes.

Needs to be able to bridge traditional art with modern digital tools effectively.

P3 - User Needs

Needs to learn new techniques (like oil painting) in a simpler, more guided way.

Needs to practice in calm, focused environments without distractions.

Needs a way to see his own improvement over time visually.

Needs to use technology as a helper, but not a replacement for real art.

P4 - User Needs

Needs a way to keep students motivated between classes.

Needs personalized ways to overcome the fear of failure.

DEEP USER NEEDS

Need 1: Needs a way to find inspiration easily when she feels stuck

- Encourage artists to share unfinished works in communal spaces so others can continue them.
- Introduce a shared system of rotating daily themes within a group or workshop to generate new ideas and routines.
- Create “inspiration collections” curated by teachers or peers, sets of reference ideas grouped by emotion, style or theme.
- Use generative AI to reinterpret a user’s past work into new styles, helping them see their own work from a fresh perspective.
- Introduce an AI “idea partner” that generates visual prompts inspired by the user’s previous drawings, mood, or chosen themes.

Need 2: Needs to be able to get feedback and guidance without joining a formal class.

- Encourage online community events, where participants can bring their work, observe others, and discuss feedback casually.
- Develop a way for artists to receive visual suggestions on their work through shared digital or printed annotations.
- Use generative AI to highlight areas of a drawing that differ from reference examples, offering gentle hints rather than grading or critique.
- Use generative AI to visualize multiple possible next steps for a drawing, helping the artist choose their own direction instead of being told what's wrong.
- An online community where the amateurs can publish their works anonymously and can get feedbacks from professionals.

Need 3: Needs a way to stay motivated

- Encourage artists to look back at earlier drawings in guided reflection sessions to recognize visible progress and personal growth.
- Create small, self-chosen drawing challenges or goals that focus on consistency rather than results.
- Organize recurring community drawing nights where participants share their process and experiences to sustain motivation together.
- Introduce short reflection prompts after each drawing, inviting users to note their emotions, energy, or inspiration level.
- Use generative AI to suggest new creative challenges or techniques based on the user's past works and current interests.

Need 4: Needs a way to explore and improve artistic techniques.

- Create guided experimentation sessions where artists test new materials or techniques under supervision, reducing waste and frustration.
- Encourage hybrid practice routines that combine digital sketching for planning with traditional painting for final results.
- Use generative AI to simulate outcomes of different materials or brush techniques before applying them on canvas.
- Offer simple proportion and color-planning exercises supported by AR or VR overlays, helping learners visualize structure and tone before starting.
- Use generative AI to suggest small technical exercises tailored to the artist's preferred materials or current skill focus.

Project Proposition

Brainstorm Summary

During brainstorming, we explored several ideas around feedback, motivation, and creativity support:

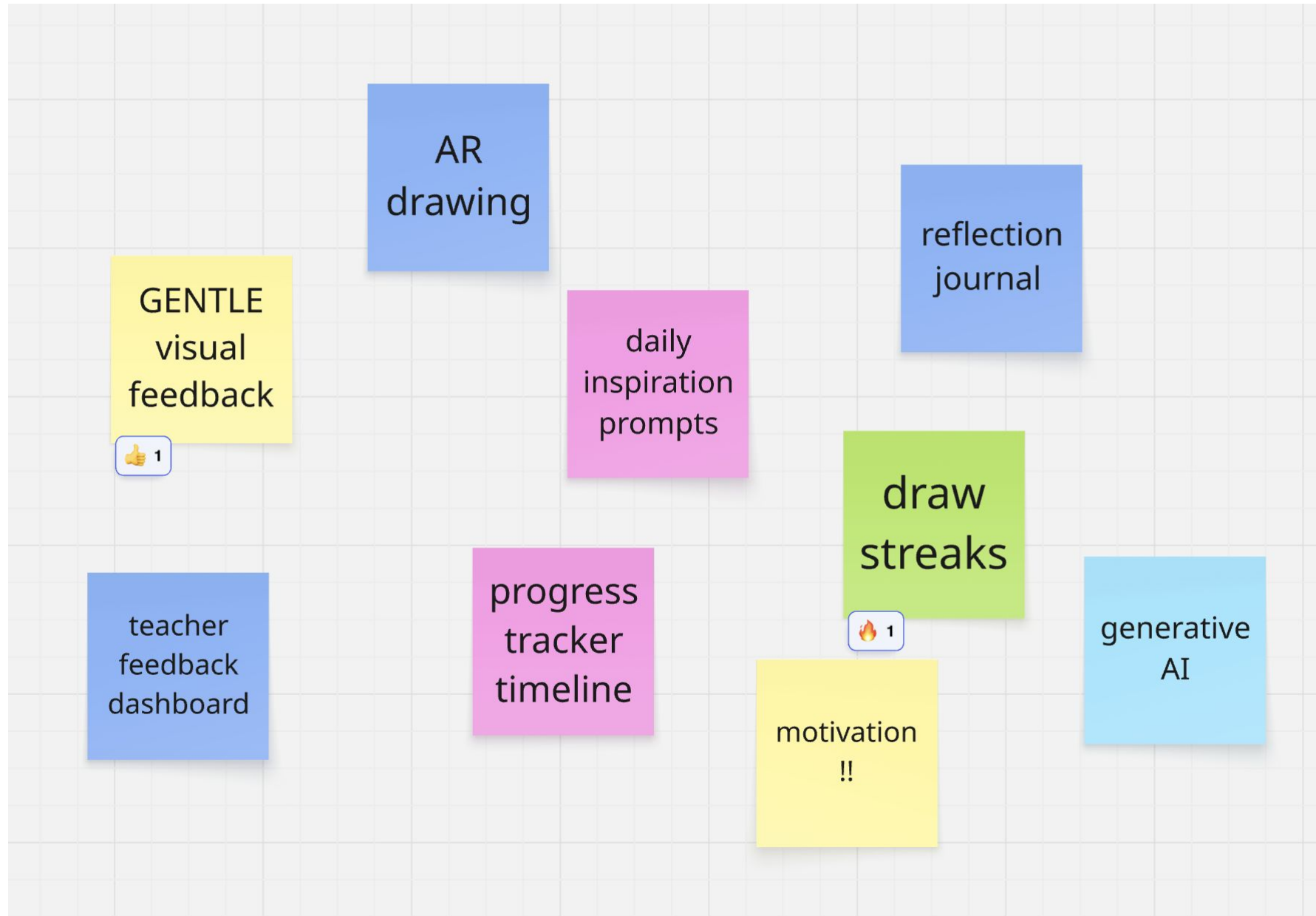
A visual feedback tool that helps beginners identify mistakes gently.

A shared sketchboard where learners can exchange feedback anonymously.

A daily inspiration generator offering small, achievable prompts.

A teacher dashboard for instructors to send visual notes between classes.

An AI assistant that gives gentle feedbacks and can analyze the progress.



Chosen Solution: “DrawTogether”

A Reflective Drawing Companion

DrawTogether is a gentle digital companion designed to help beginner and hobbyist artists grow through *reflection, inspiration, and community support*, not evaluation.

It encourages the emotional and technical sides of drawing, helping users express themselves freely while feeling guided, understood.

Connected User Needs

- Inspiration: Provides personalized prompts and AI reinterpretations of the suggested paintings.
- Feedback: Offers on-demand suggestions and letting users remain in control of their learning process.
- Motivation: Reflective progress tracking and milestones to help artists appreciate growth over time.
- Technique: Digital simulations and guided exercises encourage skill-building..

How and Why We Selected It

We selected this solution because every participant expressed the need for feedback that feels safe and supportive rather than evaluative.

The idea merges emotional motivation with gentle, on-demand AI support, making it innovative but still feasible to prototype. It's achievable with existing AI image analysis and prompt systems, while keeping the focus on human creativity and emotional comfort. The concept “**together**” reflects both community and companionship, whether with peers or the AI assistant that learns and grows with the user.